AppealDesk

# Your Homeowner Savings Guide

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## Property Tax Exemptions & Credits You May Qualify For

Based on your property in Denver County, Colorado, we have identified the following property tax exemption and credit programs that may apply to you. Each program listed below includes eligibility requirements, estimated savings, and instructions for how to apply. *Since we do not collect personal information such as age or veteran status, each program below is listed as "If you qualify..." so you can identify which programs may apply to your household.*

Senior Homestead Property Tax Exemption
Exempts 50% of the first $200,000 of the actual value of the home from property taxation.

**Estimated Savings: $500-$1,200/year**

**Eligibility:** Must be 65 or older and have occupied the property as a primary residence for at least 10 consecutive years.
**Deadline:** July 15 for new applicants (no annual renewal required)
**Form:** Application through your county assessor
**Apply:** https://dola.colorado.gov/dpt/property-taxation/property-tax-exemptions
No income limit. The 10-year occupancy requirement is the main restriction. Once approved, it continues automatically until you move or no longer qualify. This is one of the more generous senior exemptions in the country.

Disabled Veteran Homestead Exemption
Same 50% of first $200,000 exemption as the senior exemption, available to veterans with a 100% permanent disability rating.

**Estimated Savings: $500-$1,200/year**

**Eligibility:** Must be a veteran rated as 100% permanently disabled by the VA. Must occupy the property as primary residence. No age or occupancy duration requirement.
**Deadline:** July 15
**Form:** Application through county assessor
**Apply:** https://dola.colorado.gov/dpt/property-taxation/property-tax-exemptions
Unlike the senior exemption, there is no 10-year occupancy requirement for disabled veterans. Surviving spouses may also qualify.

Disability

Colorado does not have a separate general disability exemption. Disabled veterans may qualify for the Disabled Veteran Homestead Exemption. Non-veteran disabled homeowners do not have a specific exemption program.

Surviving Spouse of Disabled Veteran
The surviving spouse of a qualifying disabled veteran may receive the same 50% of first $200,000 exemption.

**Estimated Savings: $500-$1,200/year**

**Eligibility:** Must be the surviving spouse of a veteran who received the disabled veteran exemption. Must continue to occupy the home. Must not have remarried.
**Deadline:** July 15
**Form:** Application through county assessor
**Apply:** https://dola.colorado.gov/dpt/property-taxation/property-tax-exemptions
The surviving spouse must apply in their own name after the veteran's death.

Assessment Cap/Freeze
Colorado does not have an assessment cap for residential property. Residential property is assessed at 6.7% of actual value (the assessment rate). The state recently passed temporary property tax relief measures that may reduce rates temporarily.

Property Tax Deferral Program
Allows qualifying homeowners to defer payment of property taxes until the home is sold.

**Estimated Savings: Defers all property taxes (interest accrues at rate set by state treasurer)**

**Eligibility:** Must be 65 or older, surviving spouse 58+, or active military. Must have owned and occupied the home for 10+ years (5 years for military).

Property Tax/Rent/Heat Credit (PTC) Rebate
Cash rebate for property taxes, rent, and heating costs for qualifying low-income individuals.

**Estimated Savings: Up to $1,044/year in combined rebates**

**Eligibility:** Must be 65 or older, surviving spouse 58+, or disabled. Income limits apply.

Source: https://dola.colorado.gov/dpt/property-taxation/property-tax-exemptions
**These programs are independent of your property assessment.** You can apply for exemptions regardless of whether you file a property tax appeal. Even if your assessment is accurate, you may be overpaying taxes simply because you have not applied for exemptions you qualify for.

Exemption programs and eligibility requirements change periodically. The information above is current as of 2026-03. Verify current requirements with your county assessor's office before applying.

# Reassessment Protection Guide

Understanding what triggers a reassessment of your property can help you protect your current assessed value and avoid unexpected tax increases.

## Actions That May Trigger Reassessment

- **Building permits:** Pulling a permit for renovations, additions, or structural changes will typically notify the assessor of improvements to your property.
- **Major visible renovations:** Exterior improvements such as new roofing, siding, additions, or added structures (pools, garages, ADUs) may prompt a reassessment even without a permit.
- **Listing on MLS:** Listing your home for sale, even temporarily, can expose a higher market value to the assessor, especially if the listing price significantly exceeds your current assessed value.
- **Refinance appraisals:** In some jurisdictions, a high appraisal obtained during refinancing can become part of the public record and influence your assessment.
- **Insurance rebuild valuations:** Replacement cost estimates from insurance claims can signal a higher property value.
- **Adding structures:** Pools, accessory dwelling units (ADUs), detached garages, and other permanent structures increase your property's value.

## How to Protect Your Current Assessment

- **Document your home's current condition:** Take dated photos showing any deferred maintenance, needed repairs, or functional issues. This documentation can support a lower valuation if challenged.
- **Keep records of needed repairs:** Maintain a list of deferred maintenance items (aging HVAC, roof wear, plumbing issues). These reduce your home's value relative to comparable properties.
- **Understand your reassessment schedule:** Know when your county's next reassessment year is so you are not caught off guard by changes.
- **Review your annual assessment notice:** When you receive your notice of assessed value, compare it to the prior year and to recent comparable sales in your neighborhood.

**Your state's reassessment cycle:** Colorado reassesses property on a annual basis. Understanding this cycle helps you anticipate when your assessment might change.

## What to Do If Your Assessment Increases

If your assessed value increases significantly, you have the right to appeal. The key steps are:

- Review your appeal deadline (see the Appeal Window section of this packet)
- Gather comparable sales data showing your home's actual market value
- Document any property-specific factors that reduce value (condition issues, location drawbacks, functional obsolescence)
- File your appeal before the deadline

AppealDesk can generate a comprehensive evidence packet if your assessment rises in the future. Visit https://www.appealdesk.com to get started.

## Understanding Your Property Tax Bill

Your property tax bill includes more than just the base property tax. Understanding each component helps you identify which charges can be challenged and where potential savings exist.

### How Your Tax Is Calculated

The core formula is: **Assessed Value x Tax Rate = Base Property Tax**. Your total bill then adds special district assessments, voter-approved bonds, and various fees on top of this base amount.

### Common Line Items You May See

- **School district levy:** Typically the largest portion (often 40-50% of total). Funds local public schools and sometimes community colleges.
- **County general fund:** Covers county services including roads, courts, public safety, and administration.
- **City/municipal tax:** Funds city services such as police, fire, parks, and infrastructure. Only applies if you live within city limits.
- **Fire/emergency services district:** Funds local fire protection and emergency medical services. Common in unincorporated areas.
- **Library district:** Funds local library operations and programs.
- **Stormwater/drainage fees:** Based on impervious surface area. Some jurisdictions bill these separately from the tax bill.
- **Voter-approved bonds:** Debt service on bonds approved by voters for schools, infrastructure, parks, or other public projects.
- **Solid waste assessment:** Some jurisdictions include trash collection fees on the property tax bill.
- **Special improvement districts:** Charges for lighting, sidewalks, or other neighborhood-level improvements.

### Which Charges Can Be Challenged?

Challengeable **Ad valorem (value-based) taxes:** The core property tax based on your assessed value. This is what a property tax appeal addresses. Reducing your assessed value reduces this portion of your bill proportionally.

Separate Process **Special assessments and fees:** Flat-rate charges for specific services (stormwater, solid waste, special districts) often have their own dispute process. Contact your county for details.

Not Challengeable **Voter-approved bonds:** Bond levies approved at the ballot box generally cannot be individually challenged through the appeal process.

### Where Your Tax Dollars Typically Go

While the exact breakdown varies by jurisdiction, a typical distribution of property tax revenue is:

| ~45% | ~25% | ~15% | ~15% |
|---|---|---|---|
| Schools | County Services | City/Municipal | Special Districts |

These are national averages. Your jurisdiction's breakdown may differ. Check your tax bill or county website for the exact distribution.

## Energy Savings & Rebate Finder

Beyond property tax savings, significant financial incentives are available for home energy improvements. Many homeowners are unaware of these programs, which can save hundreds to thousands of dollars per year on energy costs.

### Federal Programs (Available Nationwide)

Energy Efficient Home Improvement Credit (25C)
Tax credit of up to $3,200/year for qualifying home energy improvements including insulation, exterior doors, windows, central air conditioners, heat pumps, water heaters, and electrical panel upgrades.

**Up to $3,200/year ($1,200 general limit + $2,000 for heat pumps/heat pump water heaters)**

**Eligibility:** Available to all homeowners for improvements to their primary residence. Must meet ENERGY STAR or other efficiency standards.
**How to claim:** Claim on your federal tax return using IRS Form 5695. Keep receipts and manufacturer certification statements.
Available through: Through December 31, 2032
**Details:** https://www.energystar.gov/about/federal_tax_credits/tax_credits_702

Residential Clean Energy Credit (25D)
30% tax credit on the cost of solar panels, solar water heaters, battery storage, geothermal heat pumps, fuel cells, and small wind turbines.

**30% of total system cost (no maximum limit)**

**Eligibility:** Available to homeowners for installations on any home they own (primary or secondary). Must be a new installation, not previously used.
**How to claim:** Claim on your federal tax return using IRS Form 5695. Unused credit can carry forward to future tax years.
Available through: 30% through 2032, then 26% in 2033, 22% in 2034
**Details:**
https://www.energystar.gov/about/federal_tax_credits/renewable_energy_tax_credits

High-Efficiency Electric Home Rebate Act (HEEHRA)
Point-of-sale rebates for electrification upgrades: up to $8,000 for heat pumps, $1,750 for heat pump water heaters, $840 for electric stoves/dryers, $4,000 for electrical panel upgrades, and $1,600 for insulation.

**Up to $14,000 total in rebates per household**

**Eligibility:** Income-qualified: households earning less than 150% of area median income get the largest rebates. Moderate-income households (150-200% AMI) get

50% rebates. Above 200% AMI are not eligible for HEEHRA rebates.
**How to claim:** Applied as a point-of-sale discount through participating contractors. Check with your state energy office for availability.
Available through: Funds available until September 30, 2031 or until exhausted
**Details:** https://www.energy.gov/scep/home-energy-rebates-programs

## Colorado Programs

Xcel Energy Rebate Programs
Colorado's largest utility offers extensive rebates for insulation, air sealing, HVAC, water heaters, EV chargers, and whole-home performance.
**Details:** https://co.my.xcelenergy.com/s/residential
Xcel Energy offers some of the most generous utility rebates in the country, including up to $3,000 for heat pump installations.

Colorado EnergySmart Program
Local programs in many Colorado communities providing free or low-cost energy assessments and rebates for efficiency improvements.
Programs vary by municipality. Boulder, Denver, and Fort Collins have particularly active programs.

Colorado Solar Property Tax Exemption
Solar energy systems are exempt from property tax assessment in Colorado.
Automatic exemption. Your property taxes will not increase from installing solar panels.

Contact Xcel Energy, Black Hills Energy, or your local electric cooperative for current rebate programs.

## Where to Start

For maximum savings, energy efficiency experts recommend this order of improvements:

1. **Air sealing and insulation first.** This has the highest return on investment and enables right-sizing of HVAC equipment. Typical savings: 15-30% on heating and cooling costs.
2. **HVAC heat pump upgrade.** Heat pumps provide both heating and cooling, qualify for the largest rebates, and can reduce energy costs by 30-50% compared to traditional systems.
3. **Water heater replacement.** Heat pump water heaters use 60-70% less energy than conventional models and qualify for substantial rebates.

Federal tax credits require filing IRS Form 5695 with your annual tax return. State and utility programs may have different application processes. Program availability and amounts are subject to change. Consult with a tax professional regarding your specific eligibility.

## Property Tax Watch: Continuous Assessment Monitoring

As more comparable sales data becomes available in your area, your case for an appeal may strengthen. Property Tax Watch monitors your assessment year-round and alerts you to changes and new opportunities.

- ✓ **Annual assessment change alerts** delivered to your inbox when your county updates your property value
- ✓ **Automatic overassessment detection** comparing your assessed value against current market data
- ✓ **Filing deadline reminders** so you never miss your window to appeal

**Activate Your Free 12-Month Monitoring**

https://www.appealdesk.com/tax-watch

## Appeal Window & Deadline Summary

In Colorado, the process for challenging your property assessment is called an "appeal." Here is what you need to know about timing and deadlines for Denver County.

Mark Your Calendar
**Colorado Appeal Deadline: June 1**
**Review Board:** County Board of Equalization
**County:** Denver County, Colorado

The typical appeal window in Colorado is **May – June**. During this period, homeowners can file a formal appeal of their assessed property value.

When Your Appeal Window Opens
Your appeal window typically opens when you receive your **Notice of Assessment** from the county. This notice is mailed to property owners, usually in the spring. **Keep this notice.** You will need it to file your appeal. It contains your property identification number, current assessed value, and instructions for filing.

### Colorado Appeal Process

If you choose to appeal, the process follows these levels:

1. County Assessor (Informal)
2. County Board of Equalization
3. Board of Assessment Appeals / District Court

An **informal review** is available before the formal hearing in most jurisdictions. This is often the fastest path to resolution.

If you need a complete evidence packet to support your appeal, AppealDesk can generate one with comparable sales analysis, a cover letter, and filing instructions tailored to your property. Visit https://www.appealdesk.com to get started.



This guide is for informational purposes. Exemption eligibility and program details should be verified with your county assessor's office before applying. Energy rebate programs are subject to change and funding availability. Consult with a tax professional regarding your specific eligibility for tax credits.